

IN PROFILE

Josephine von Brunsvik

A countess from Hungary, Josephine von Brunsvik took piano lessons with Beethoven in 1799, shortly before her marriage to Count Joseph Deym. After the count's death in 1804, Beethoven expressed his love for Josephine in a series of passionate letters. In 1810, she married Estonian nobleman Cristoph von Stackelberg. The marriage soon broke up in mutual acrimony. Josephine was probably the "Immortal Beloved" referred to by Beethoven in a letter in 1811, and they may have met for the last time as late as 1816. After miserable final years of illness and isolation, Josephine died in 1821 aged 42.



BRUNSVIK CASTLE NEAR BUDAPEST, HOME OF JOSEPHINE

Musical innovation

Beethoven's early compositions were predominantly piano works that he performed himself, but the publication of his Opus 1 Piano Trios in 1795 proved a commercial success and he was soon responding to a flood of commissions for new works from music publishers and